

13 sep 2017

Hi Mike,

I had a chance to compare your Y-DNA results to those of George Duerksen this morning. The match is very good. I think that this is good evidence that your ancestor Johann Cornelius #14630 was the brother to David #14628 (1761-1818).

There is no documentation showing that David's father was a Cornelius so the name David Cornelius is incorrect (and does not appear in the GRANDMA database). The Menn. Rundschau source below is for the birth of George Duerksen.

Here are a few pieces of circumstantial evidence that Johann Cornelius and David were likely brothers (or, at least closely related):

- 1) The Y-DNA match of the direct male descendants of Johann Cornelius and David. Especially since these two do not match any of the other Dirks/Dirksen/etc. men and represent a rather small family group (which may have originated with a Kerber man)
- 2) Johann Cornelius and David were born in the same small region of West Prussia (the Tragheimerweide congregation)
- 3) Johann Cornelius and David were born within a few years of each other (1760s)
- 4) David Dirksen named his first son Cornelius, in accordance with the tradition.

I would not go as far as making Johann Cornelius and David brothers in the GRANDMA database. I do think that complementary notes should go with both of them showing why they were likely brothers. People could then decide for themselves.

Glenn Penner.

I added notes to 14628 and 70539 that the Y haplotypes of their descendents suggest that 14628 and 70539 were closely related to each other.

Tim Janzen

Hello Mike and Tim,

I've been looking at the ancestry of the various Dirks/Doerksen/Dirksen/Duerksen/etc. men who have participated in the Mennonite DNA project. The ancestries of the 7 men, other than Mike and George, are all Flemish or Old Flemish. This means that the only men with Frisian Mennonite ancestry in the project are Mike and George. This means two things:

- 1) the haplotypes for Mike and George may not be unique to their specific ancestry (but could be shared by all the Dirks/Doerksen/Dirksen/Duerksen/etc. men with Frisian ancestry).
- 2) the match to the Kerber men may not be unique to Mike and George.

We need more Dirks/Doerksen/Dirksen/Duerksen/etc. men of Frisian ancestry in the project in order to determine if the entire Frisian branch is related to the Kerbers. This could be similar to the main branch of the Peters family, who are related to the Hiebert/Hueberts.

I also have some suggested corrections to the families of Johann ((#14630) and David (#14628) Duerksen, which I will send in a separate email.

Glenn Penner

Mike,

You may have seen this already. If you look at <http://www.mennonitegenealogy.com/prussia/marienw.htm> and go down to #171 you'll see a Johann Dirks of Schweingrube who sold a Morgen of land in 1819. I think that it's more than just coincidence that the same year Johann Dirks of Schweingrube immigrated to Russia. I'm certain that this is your ancestor. A Morgen of land was just over 1 1/3 acres. Probably enough for a house, barn, garden and cow pasture.

Glenn Penner